

RACHEL N. SLAYBAUGH

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SUMMARY

I'm driven by connection to mission and I aim to make a difference in clean energy and sustainability. I've selected, funded, and coached many climate tech teams. I enjoy working in teams and am a good manager. I understand policy and government. I'm committed to diversity, equity, and inclusion.

EXPERIENCE & ACCOMPLISHMENTS

Data Collective Venture Capital (DCVC)

Partner

Feb. 2022 – present

Palo Alto, CA

- Source, select, fund, and support deep tech companies in the climate space
- Serve as board member or observer for Radiant, Brimstone, Fervo Energy, and Petra

Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory

Cyclotron Road Division Director

Jan. 2021 – Dec. 2021

Berkeley, CA

- Sourced and selected ~10 hard tech innovators per year for a 2-year fellowship program to turn their technology concept into a product with a positive societal impact (~\$6M/year)
- Fellows embed at LBNL where we support their technical development and collaborations
- Responsible for outcomes, safety, and reporting to Department of Energy and LBNL leadership

Advanced Research Projects Agency – Energy

Program Director

Jan. 2017 – Oct. 2020

Washington, DC

- Created programs and selected teams developing technologies for advanced nuclear fission reactors, \$95M across 28 teams: MEITNER, the Nuclear OPEN+ cohort, LISE, and GEMINA
- Provided deep technical and business guidance while managing: the nuclear teams; the TERRA and ROOTS Programs, supporting research for sensing and data analytics for above- and below-ground plant outcomes (~\$90M across 18 teams); and the FOCUS Program, supporting research for solar technologies that combine photovoltaic and concentrated solar power technologies (~\$12M across 4 teams)
- Supported program creation in other energy areas through workshops, brainstorming, and feedback

University of California, Berkeley

Associate Professor of Nuclear Engineering

Jan. 2014 – Dec. 2021

Berkeley, CA

- Founded the Nuclear Innovation Bootcamp, which brings diverse students from around the world to learn skills essential to innovation in nuclear energy
- Developing numerical methods for neutral particle transport with an emphasis on supercomputing and advanced architectures; applications in reactor design, shielding, and nonproliferation
- Also mentored PhDs in optimization, thermal fluids, and cryptography and anomaly detection
- Published 25 journal articles, 44 refereed conference proceedings, 3 technical reports, 2 book chapters, 5 open source pieces of software, and 2 policy pieces
- Graduated 9 PhD and 4 MS students; research adviser for 1 assistant project scientist, 1 postdoctoral scholar, 1 visiting scholar, and 15 undergraduate students
- Won >\$2.5M as principal investigator (PI) and >\$26M as co-PI for numerical methods research
- Created and support a course in which Berkeley students do hands on science experiments at under-served elementary schools in Oakland

Bettis Laboratory*Senior Engineer in the Shield Design and Development group*

Mar. 2012 – Aug. 2014

West Mifflin, PA

- Implemented the Forward-Weighted Consistent Adjoint Driven Importance Sampling (FW-CADIS) method and developed new resonance factor for variance reduction in Monte Carlo
- Qualified these methods and software for use in shield design to dramatically reduce time and improve accuracy in design calculations

University of Wisconsin–Madison*Research Assistant / Rickover Fellow*

Sept. 2006 – Nov. 2011

Madison, WI

- Dissertation: “Acceleration Methods for Massively Parallel Deterministic Transport” where I added 3 new methods to Denovo, software from Oak Ridge National Laboratory, that are still used
- Developed two Monte Carlo source sampling methods for arbitrarily shaped plasma sources

Penn State Breazeale Reactor*Reactor Operator*

Aug. 2003 – Apr. 2006

University Park, PA

- NRC licensed Reactor Operator for TRIGA Mark III reactor
- Analyzed core burn-up anomaly; calibrated gamma irradiation facilities

EDUCATION

Ph.D.	University of Wisconsin–Madison , Nuclear Engineering and Engineering Physics with a certificate in Energy Analysis and Policy	2011
M.S.	University of Wisconsin–Madison , Nuclear Engineering and Engineering Physics	2008
B.S.	Pennsylvania State University , Nuclear Engineering	2006

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE*Non-Profit Boards and Leadership*

LabStart Advisor	2022-prsent
National Renewable Energy Laboratory Investor Advisory Board	2021-present
National Academies of Science member of the Committee on Laying the Foundations for New and Advanced Nuclear Reactors in the United States	2020-2022
Activate Leadership Council	2021-present
Biden-Harris Transition Team, Department of Energy Agency Review Team	2020
Good Energy Collective, Founding Board Chair and Board Member	2020-present
Pennsylvania State University, Nuclear Alumni Advisory Council	2020-2021
Nuclear Science and Engineering Editorial Advisory Board	2020-present
University of Michigan, NERS Department Advisory Board	2019-2021
Nuclear Energy Advisory Committee (a U.S. FACA), Appointed Member	2016-2017

Software and Computing

Berkeley Institute for Data Science	Senior Fellow; Advisory Board Member
Berkeley Research Computing	User Advisory Group
The Hacker Within	UCB Faculty Advisor 2014-2017; UW co-founder 2009

American Nuclear Society

Math and Comp. Division	Chair rotation 2016-2019, Exec. Comm. 2013-2016
Rad. Protection and Shielding Div.	Exec. Comm. 2015-2018
other Past Chair / Vice Chair	NEED Comm, Professional Divisions Comm, Student Sections Comm, Professional Women in ANS

Reviewer for US DOE ARPA-E, Fusion Energy Sciences, Technology Commercialization Fund, Canadian Innovation Fund, and a number of journals and technical conferences